Adrian Zhang

Tracks

for small ensemble
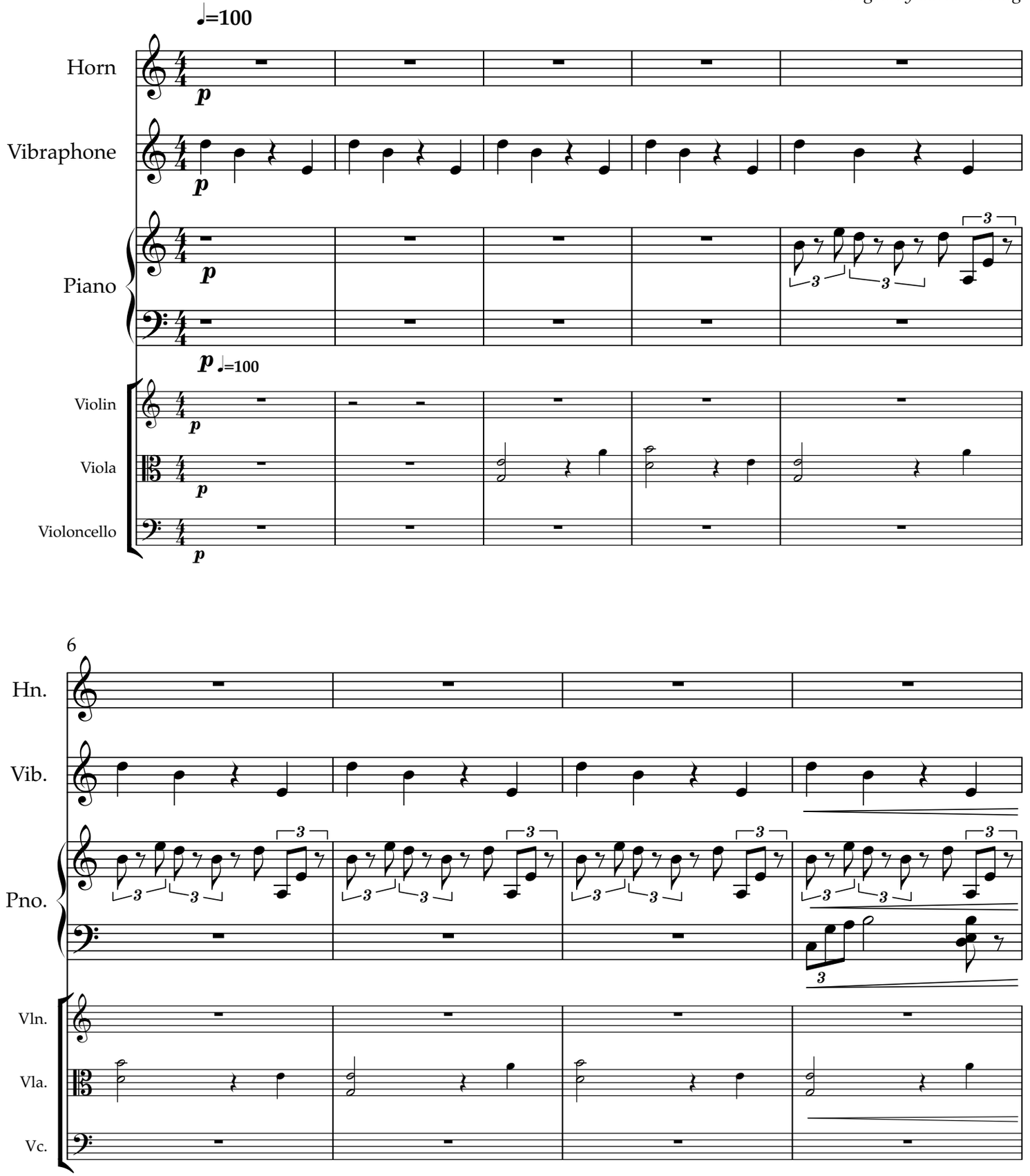
(2023)

I was inspired to write “Tracks” by listening to Steve Reich’s piece “Eight Lines”.
Tracks is a piece about a train. It is about a simple matter, one that most people do not think about any more than routine, which is why the piece itself is very minimalistic.
Like a train on the railroad, the music slowly begins. The symbolic train accelerates as the amount of instruments increases. Every once in a while, the music stops on a chord, symbolizing the stopping of the train, at a station, where passengers - or cargo - join in on the ride. This is symbolized by the notes changing somewhat each time. Some people leave, some stay. But the people on the train do not change it, so the main rhythms are kept.
That is, until the piano rhythm changes in the second part. This indicates something out of the ordinary, but when the music resolves into something with a tonal center, this means that whatever the out of the ordinary thing was, it has been fixed. The first piano rhythm comes back for a while, but evolves yet again into a slightly different version of the second piano rhythm, but it’s okay.
All in a day’s work on a train.
And as if on cue, the music simplifies...
To a stop.
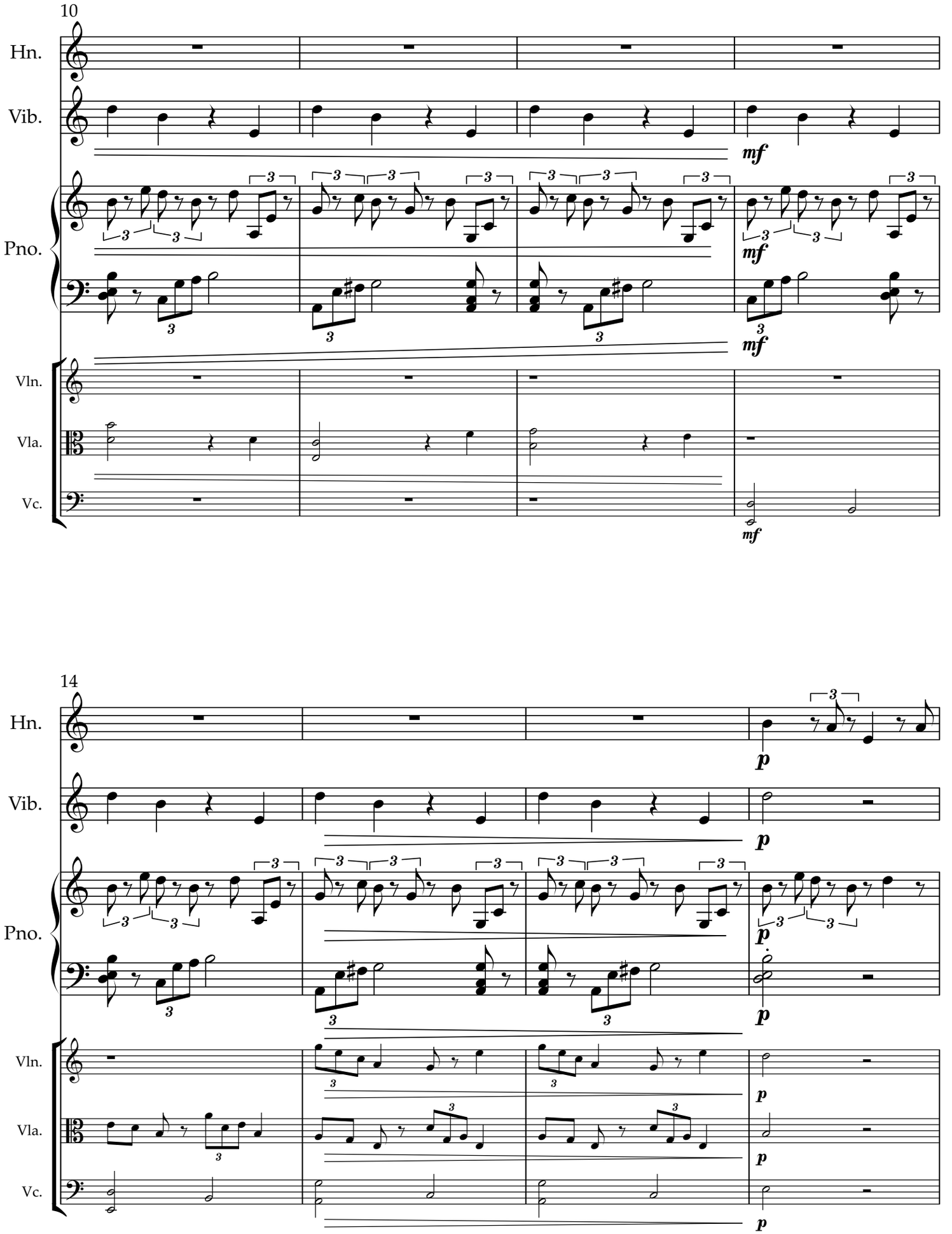
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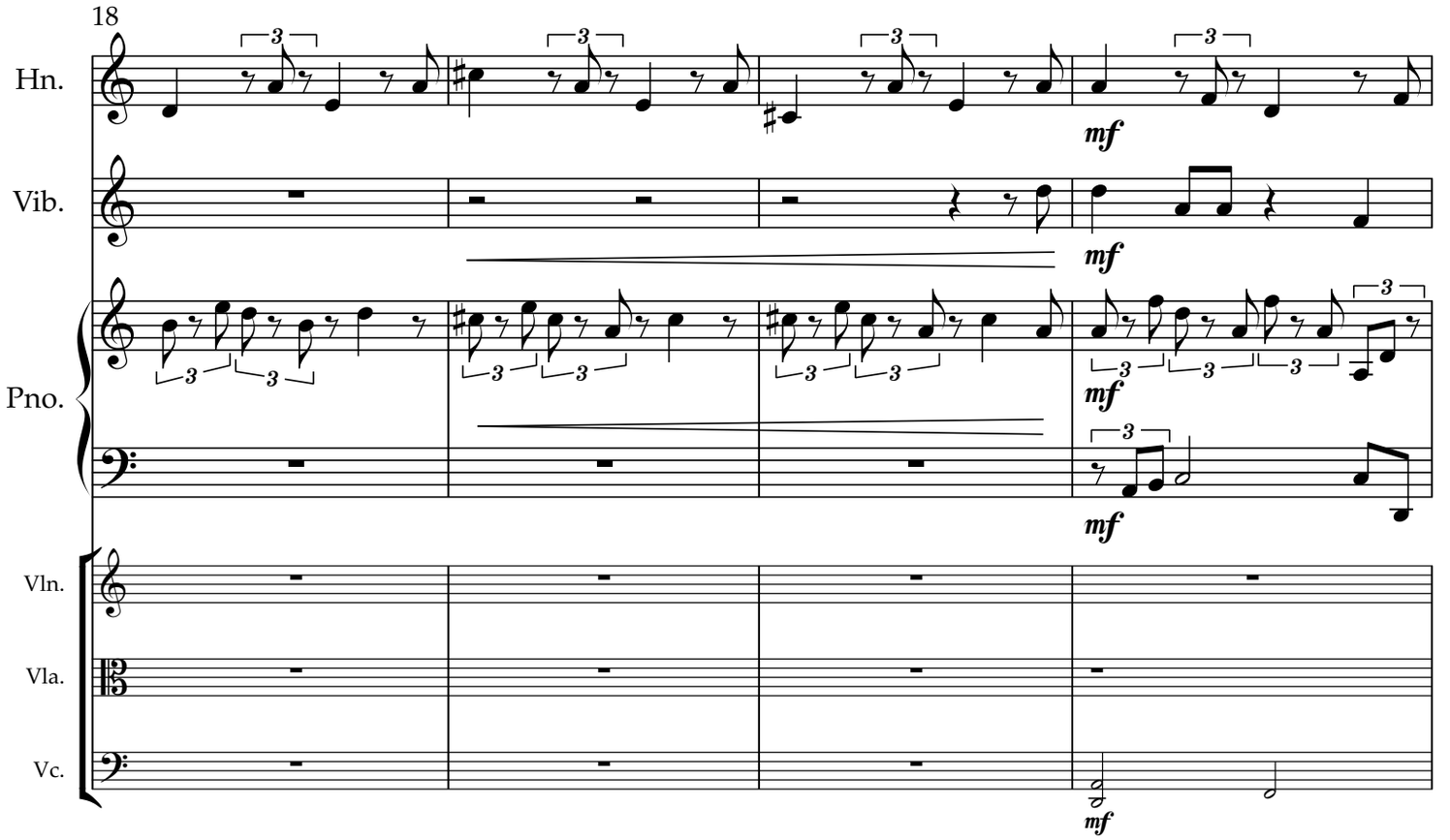
for small ensemble
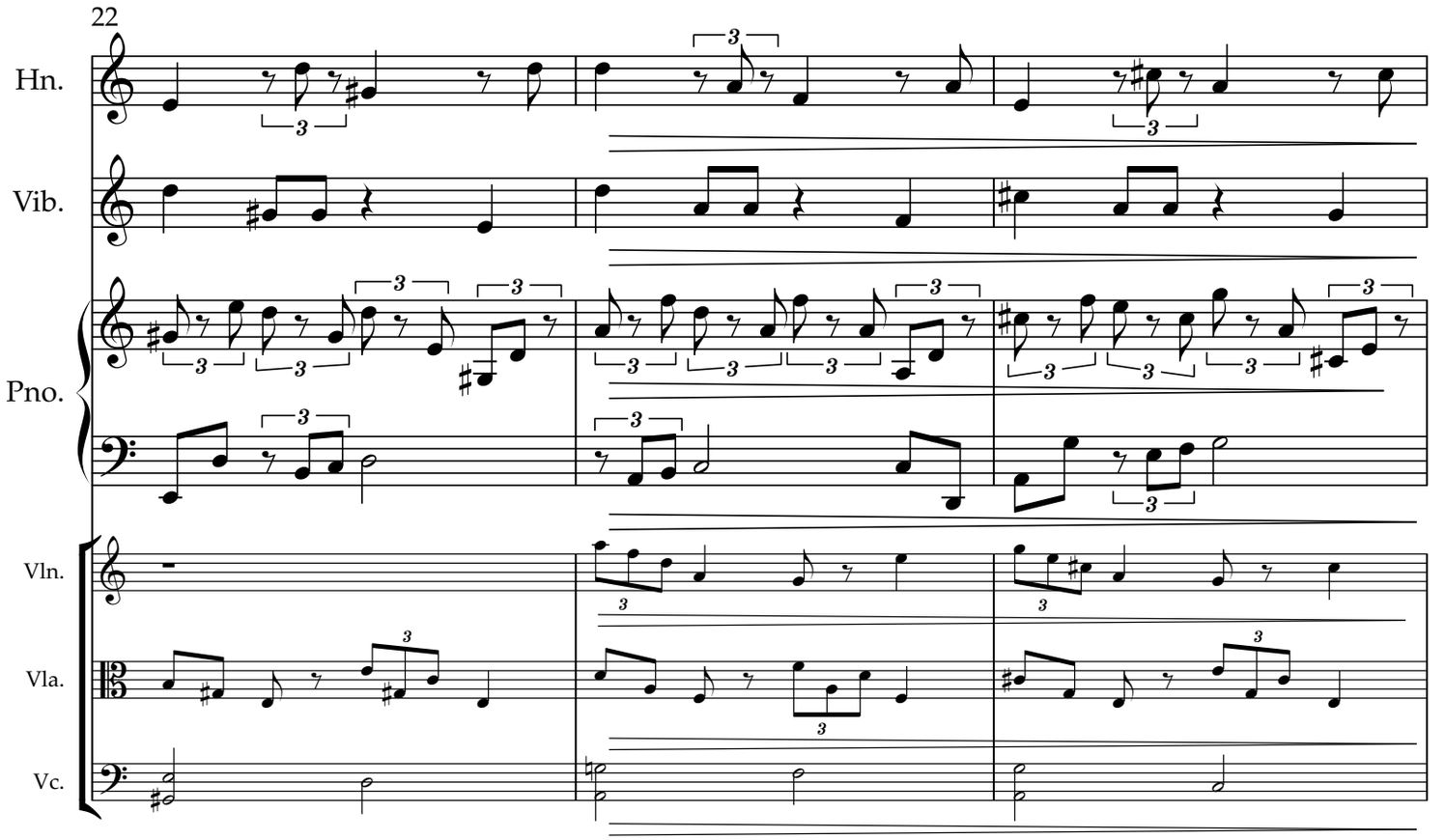
adrian zhang
Arranged by adrian zhang
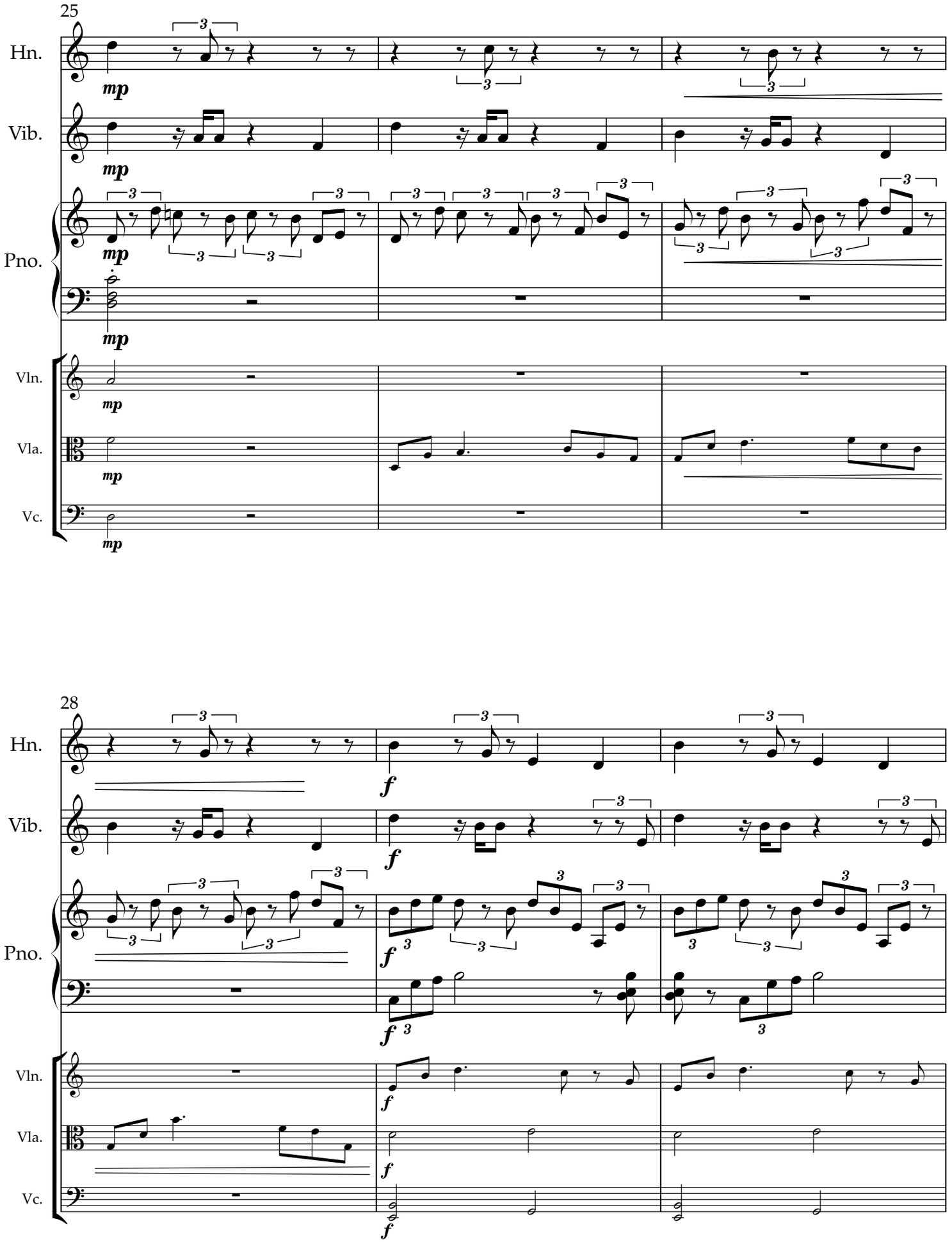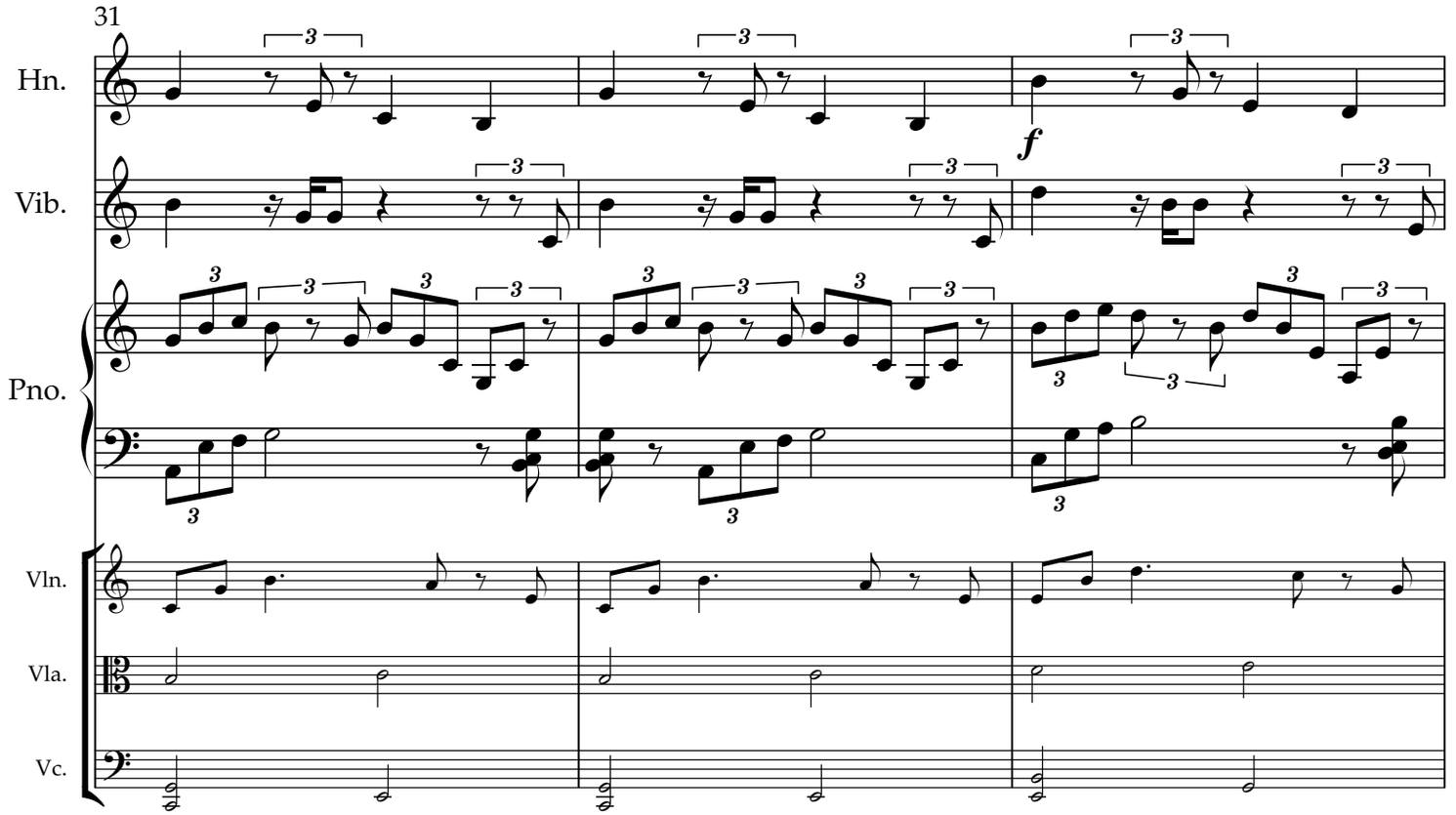


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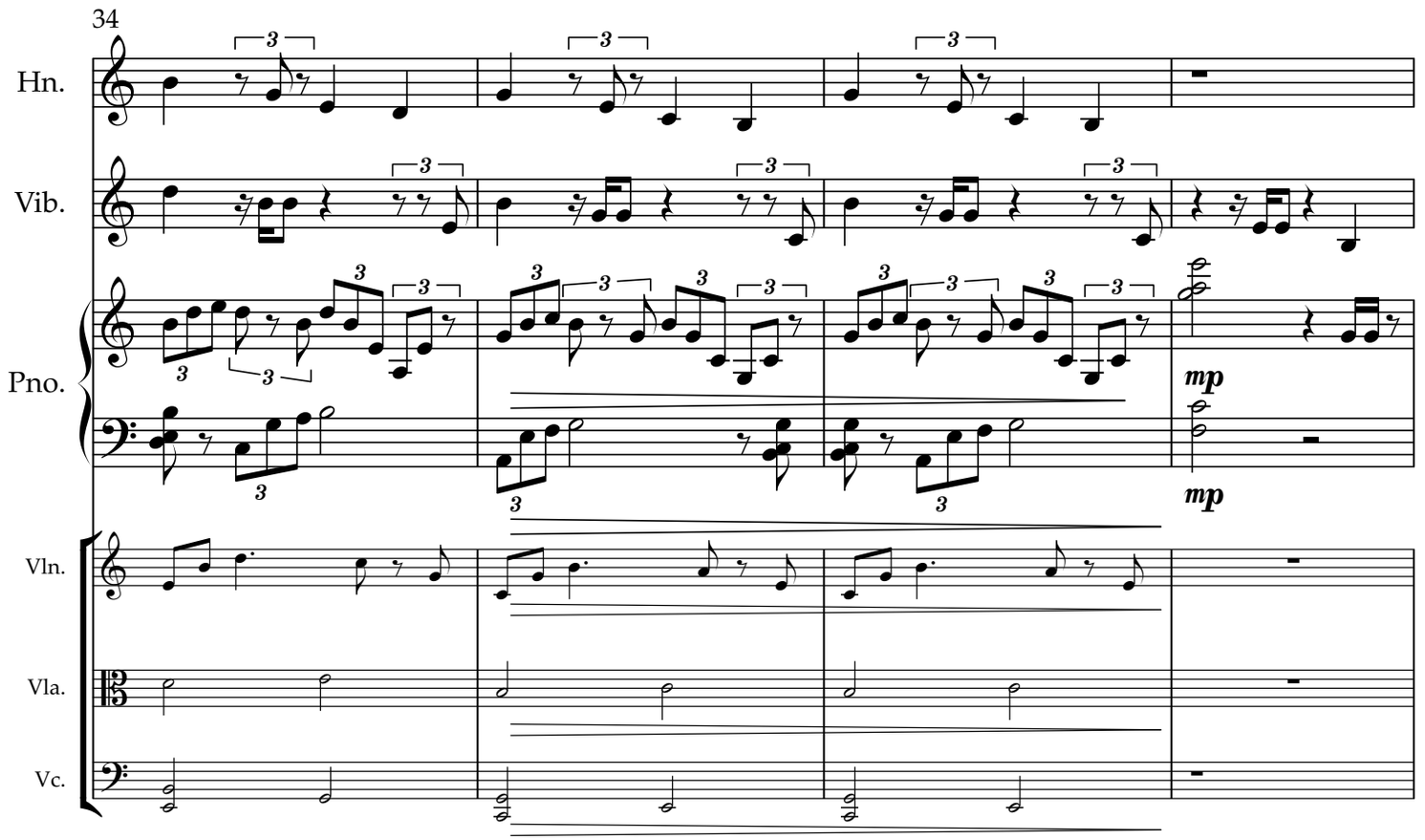

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Vla.
Vc.
mf
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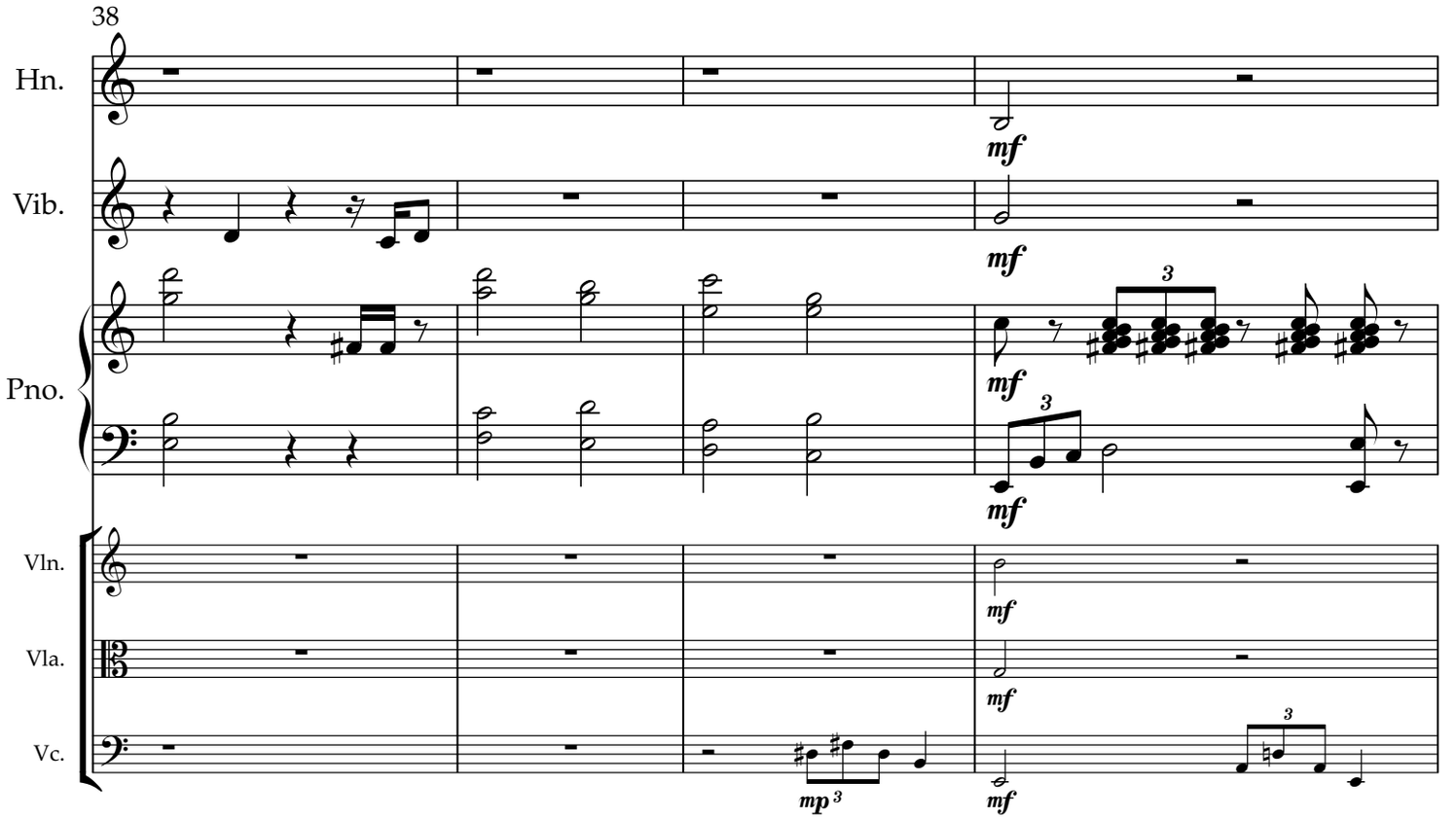

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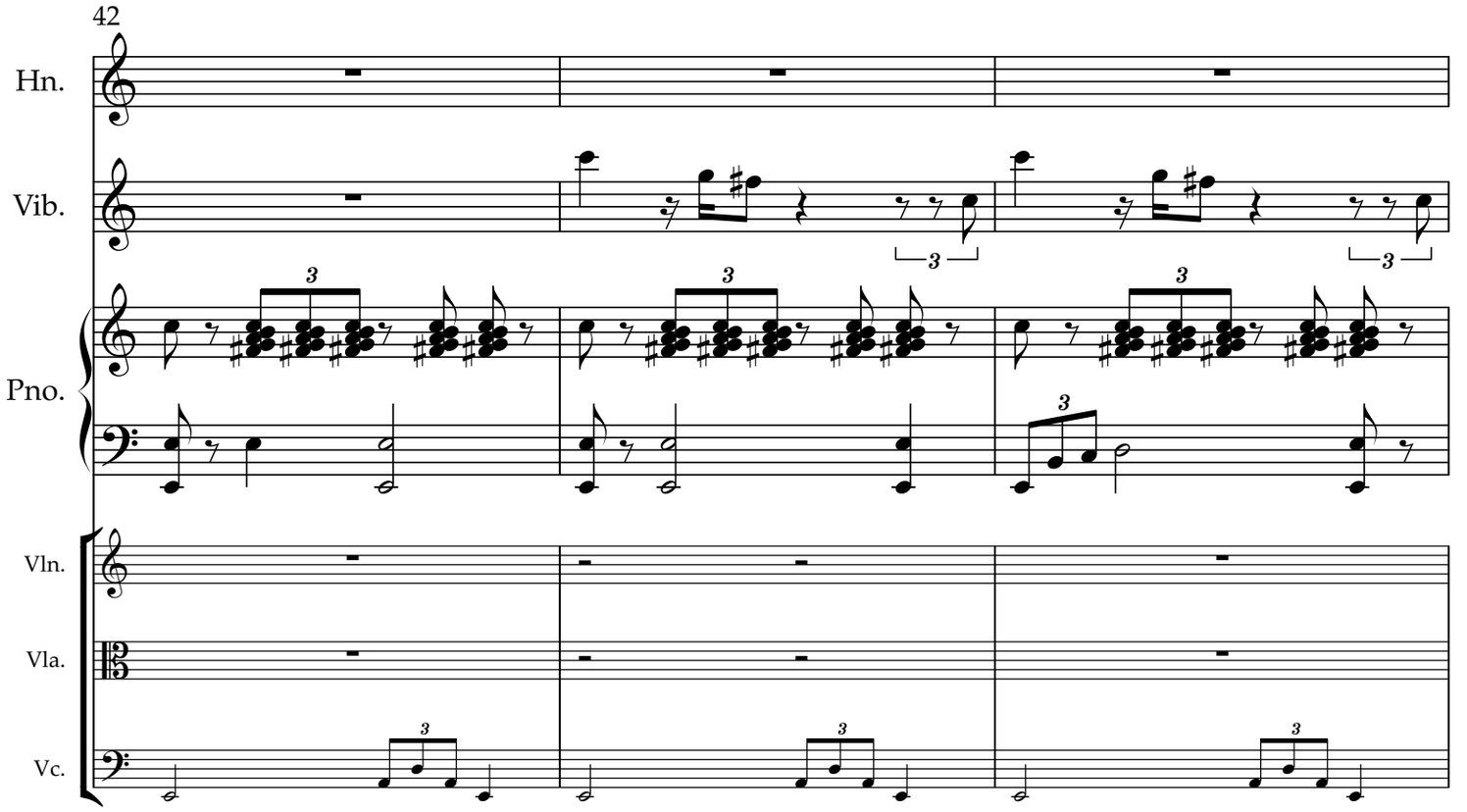

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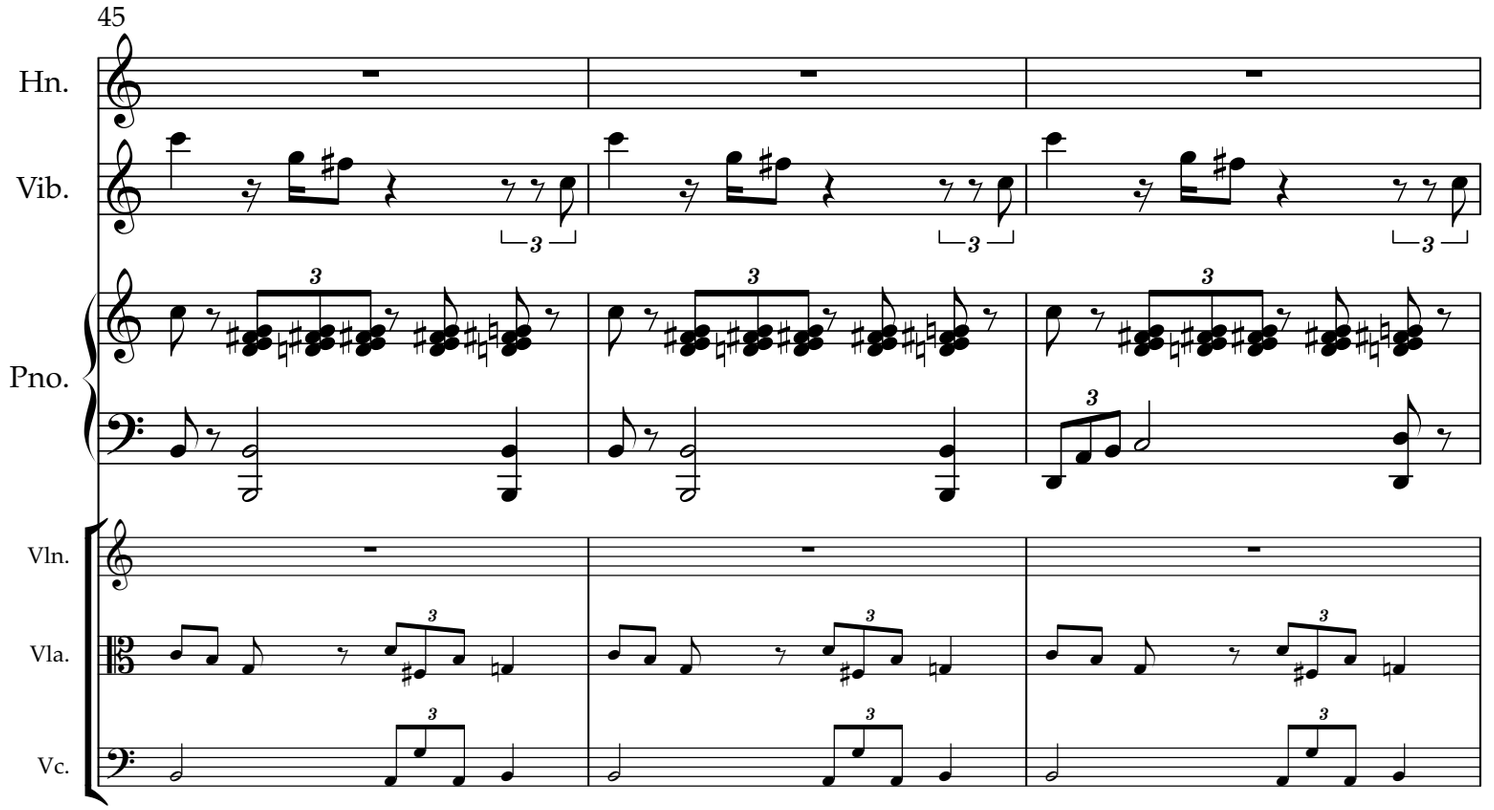

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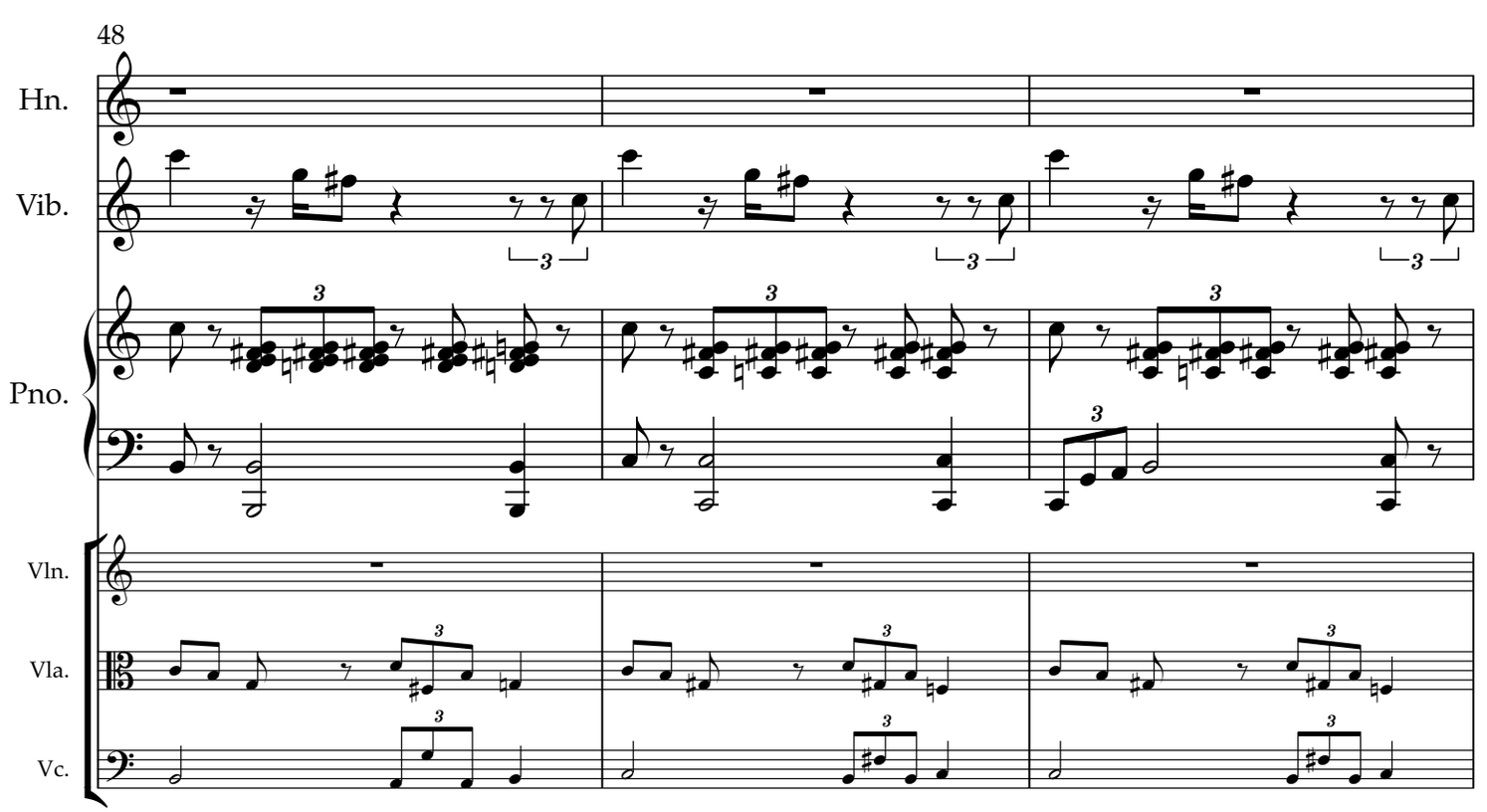

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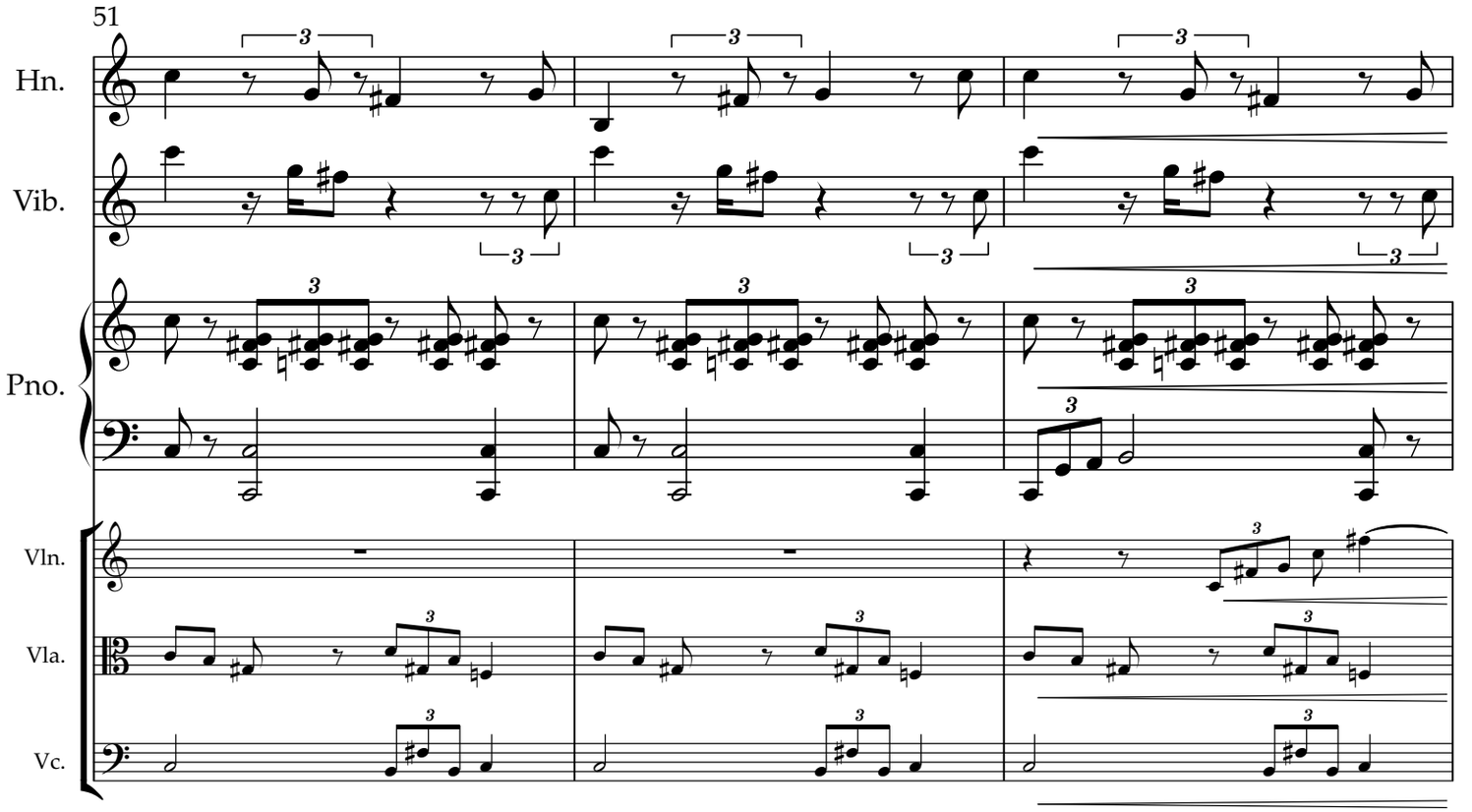

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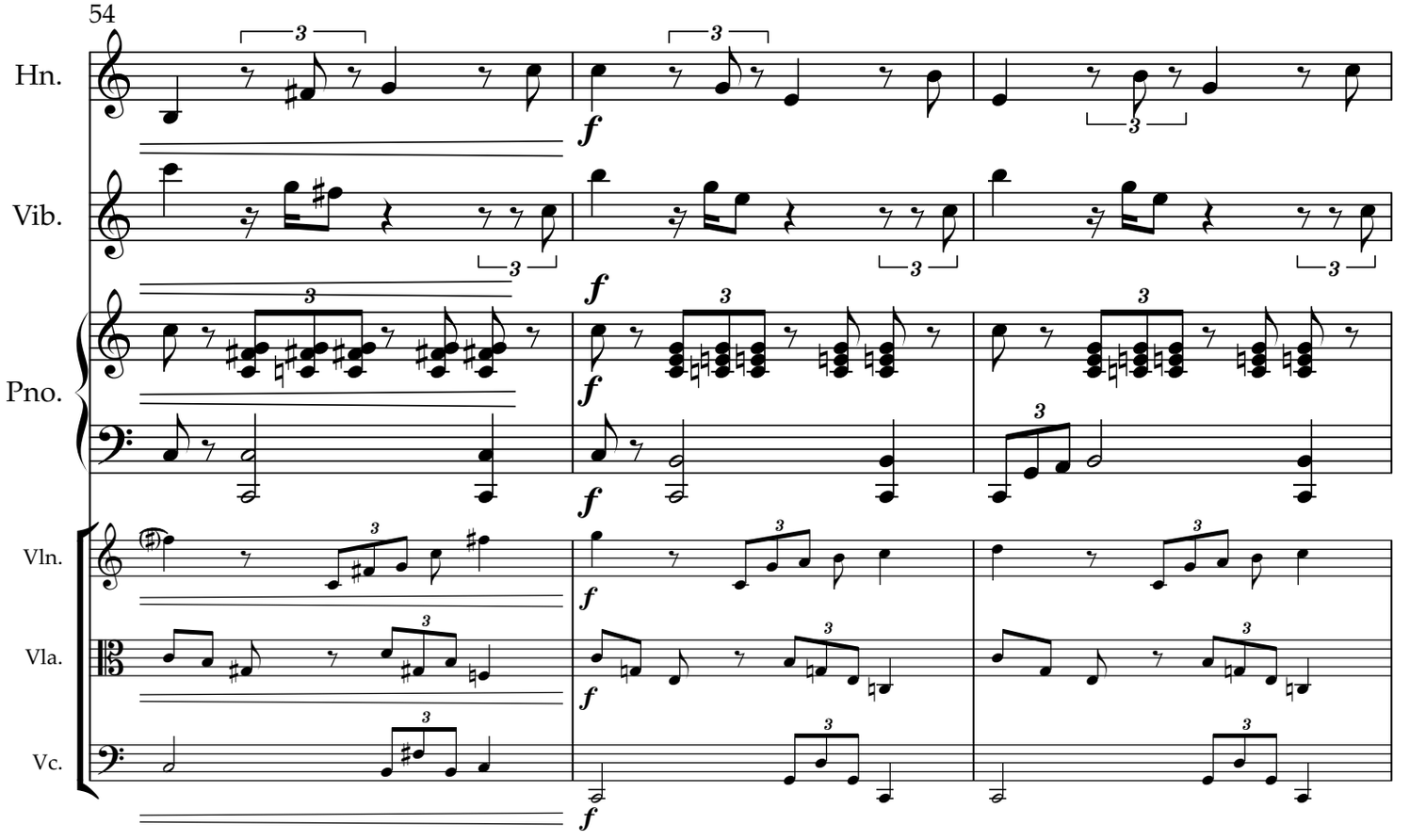

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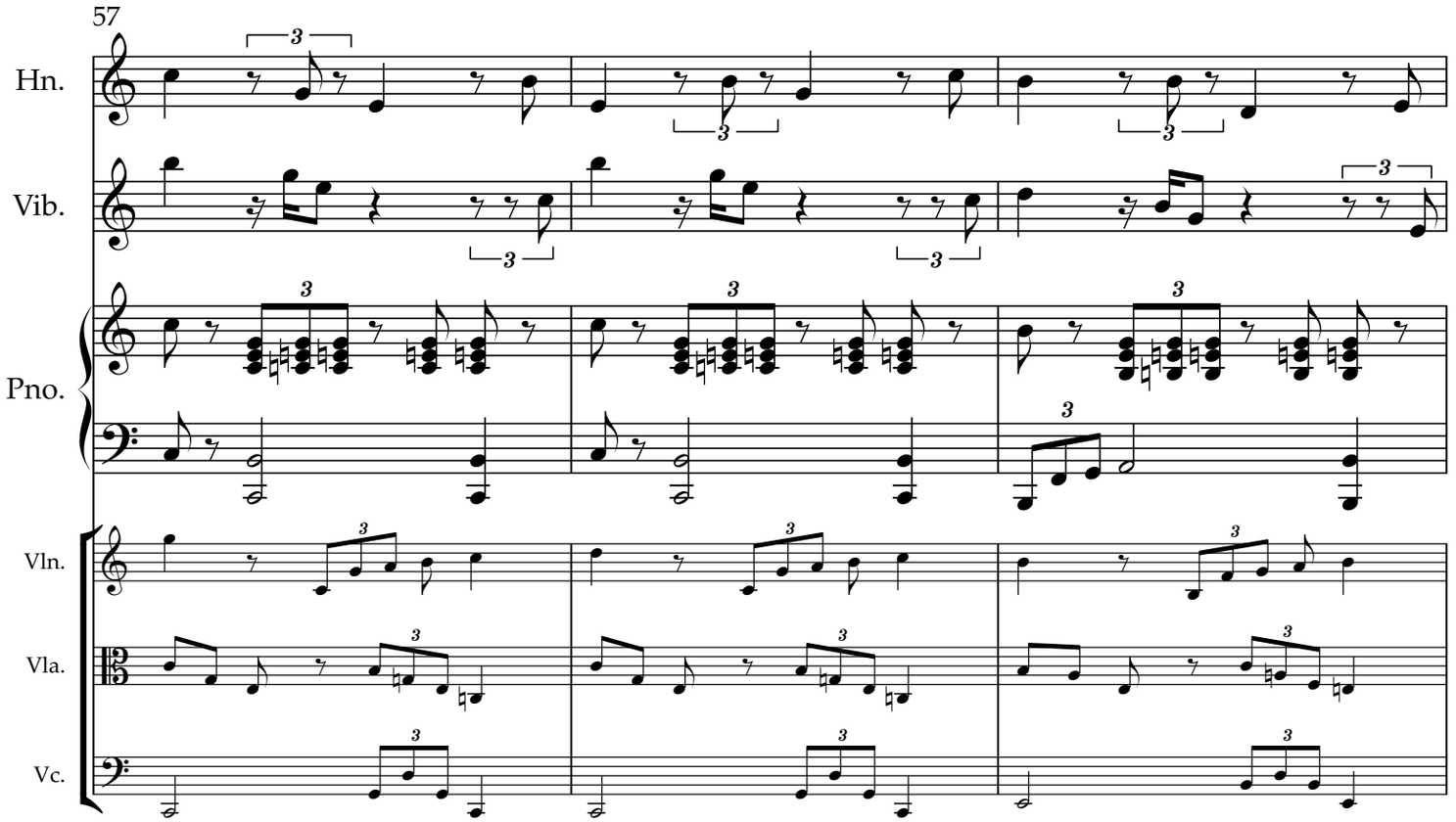

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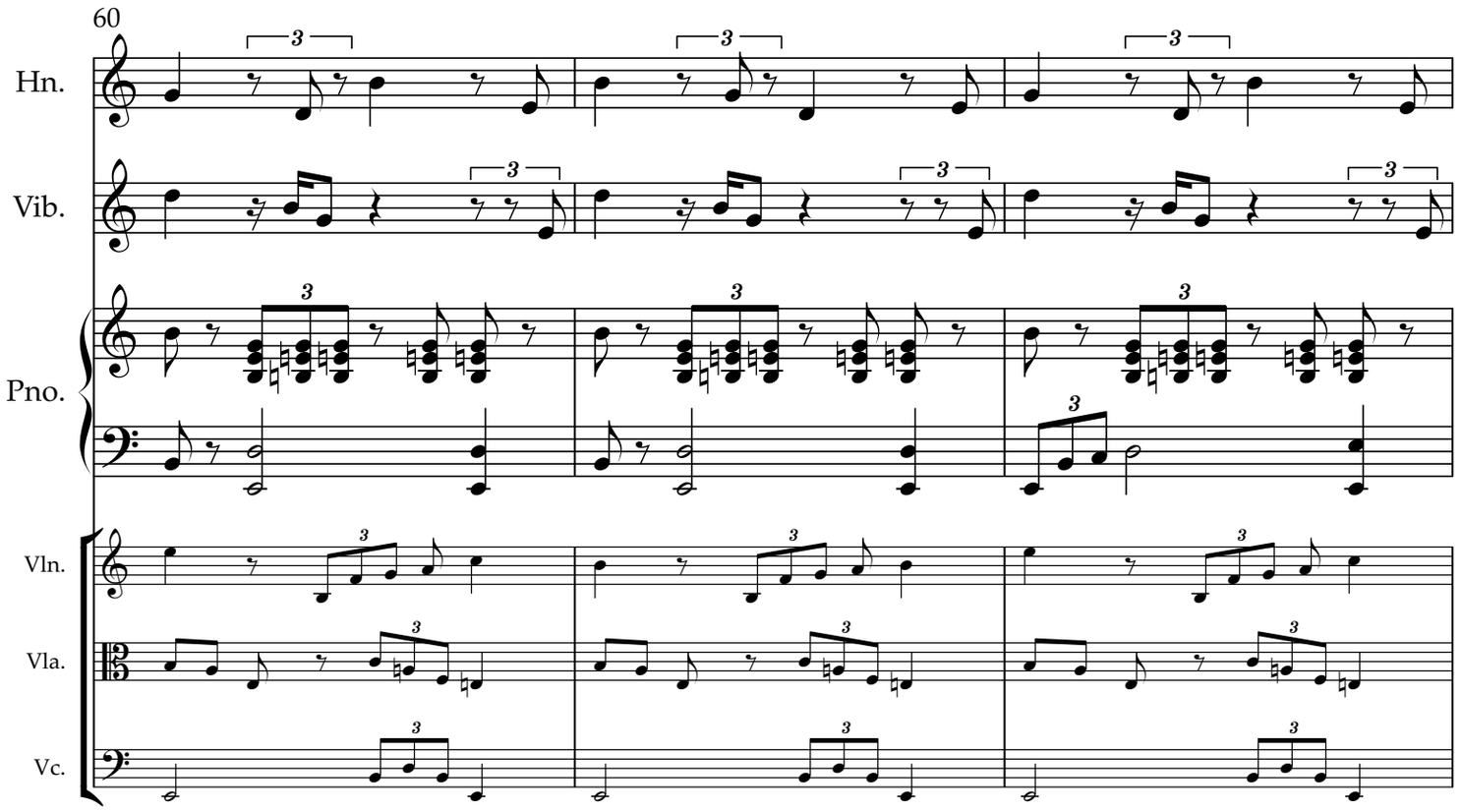

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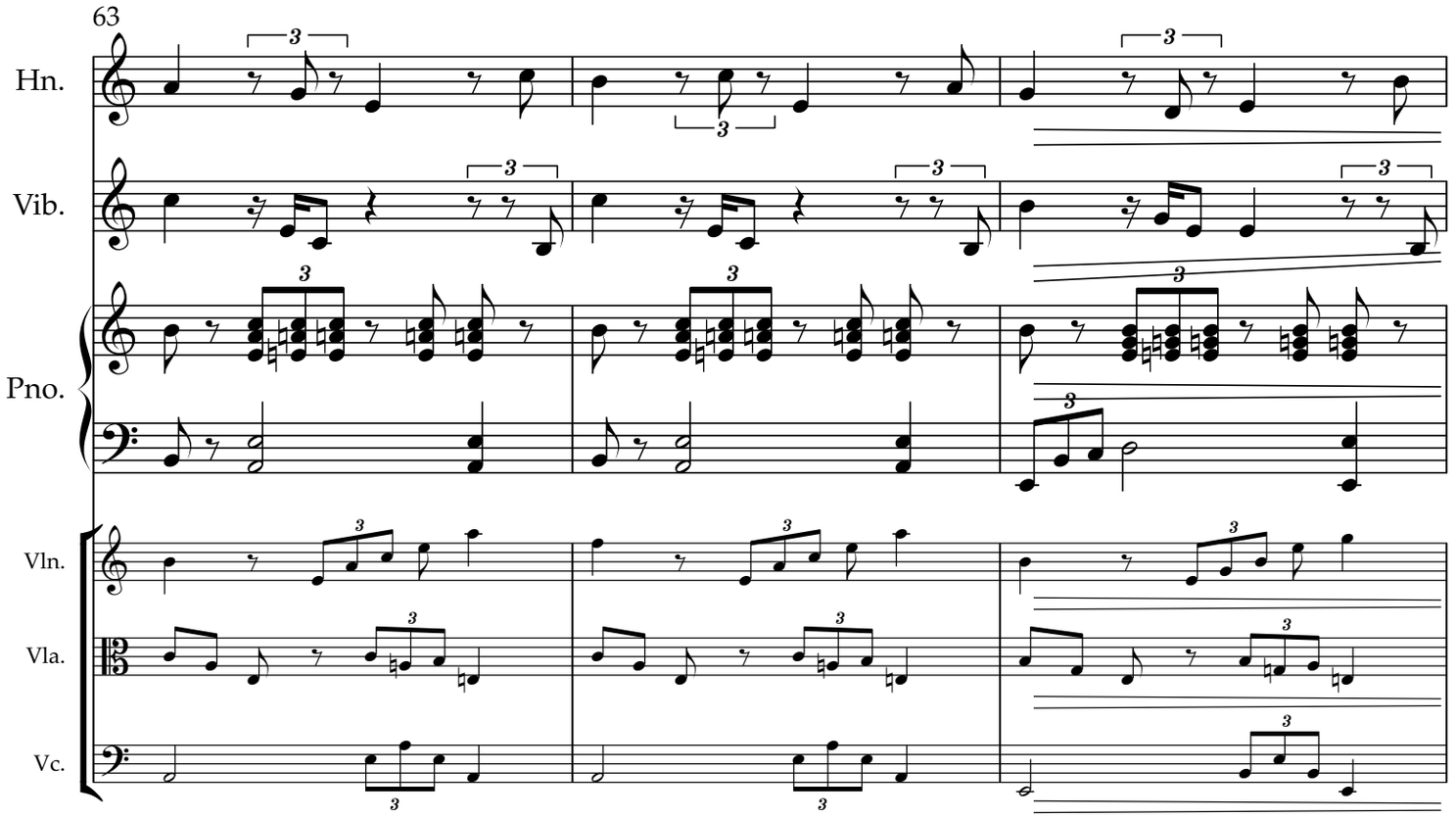

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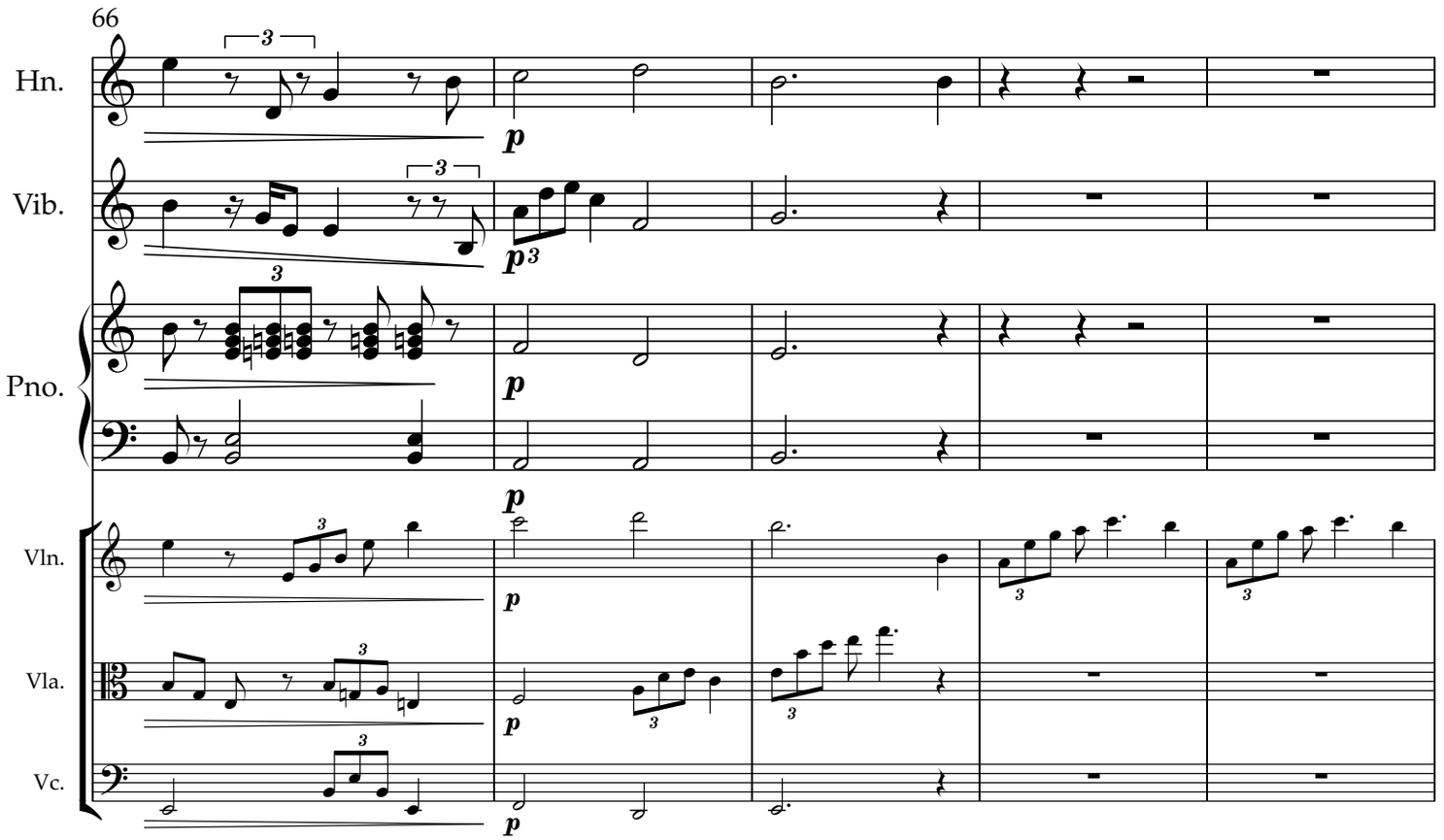

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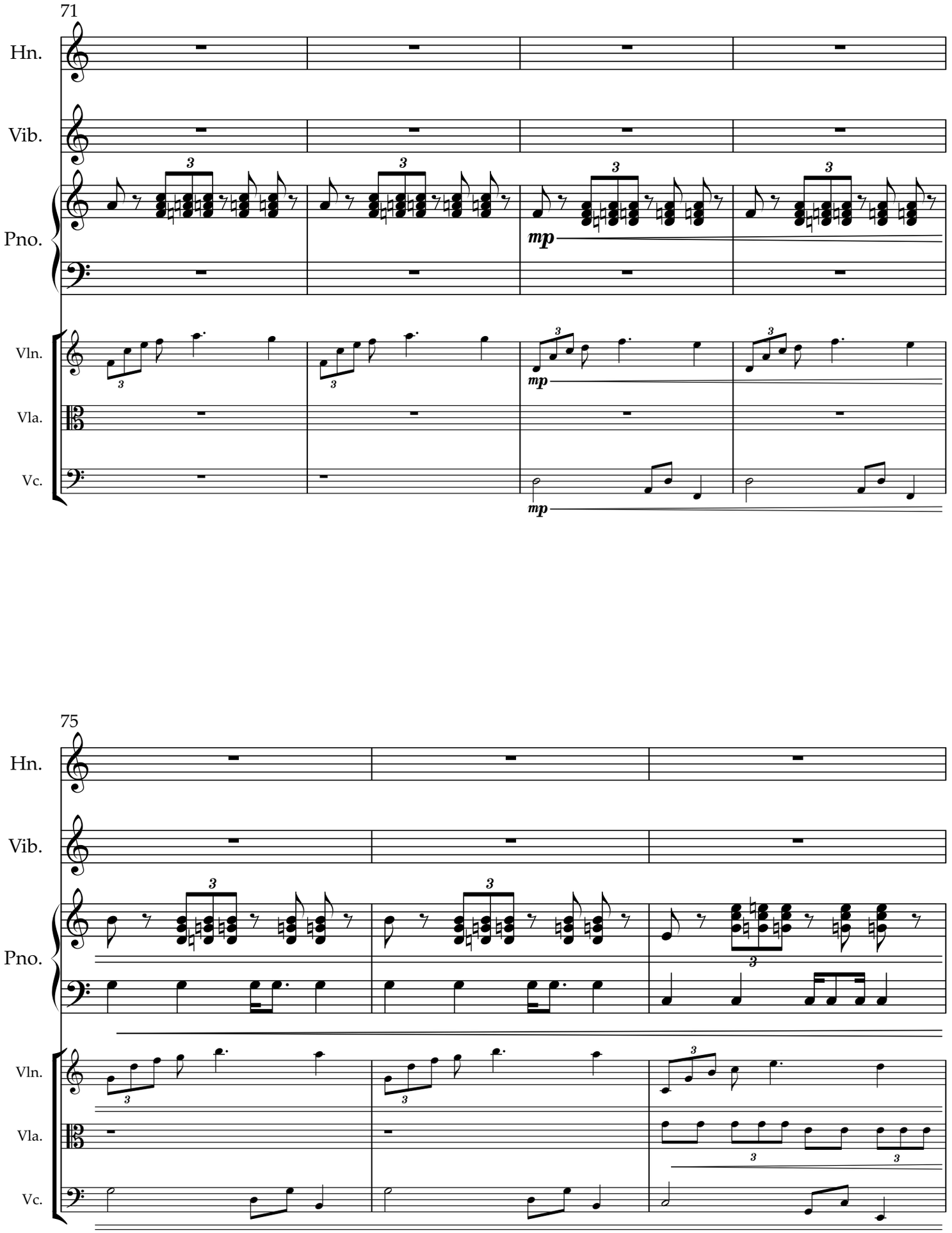

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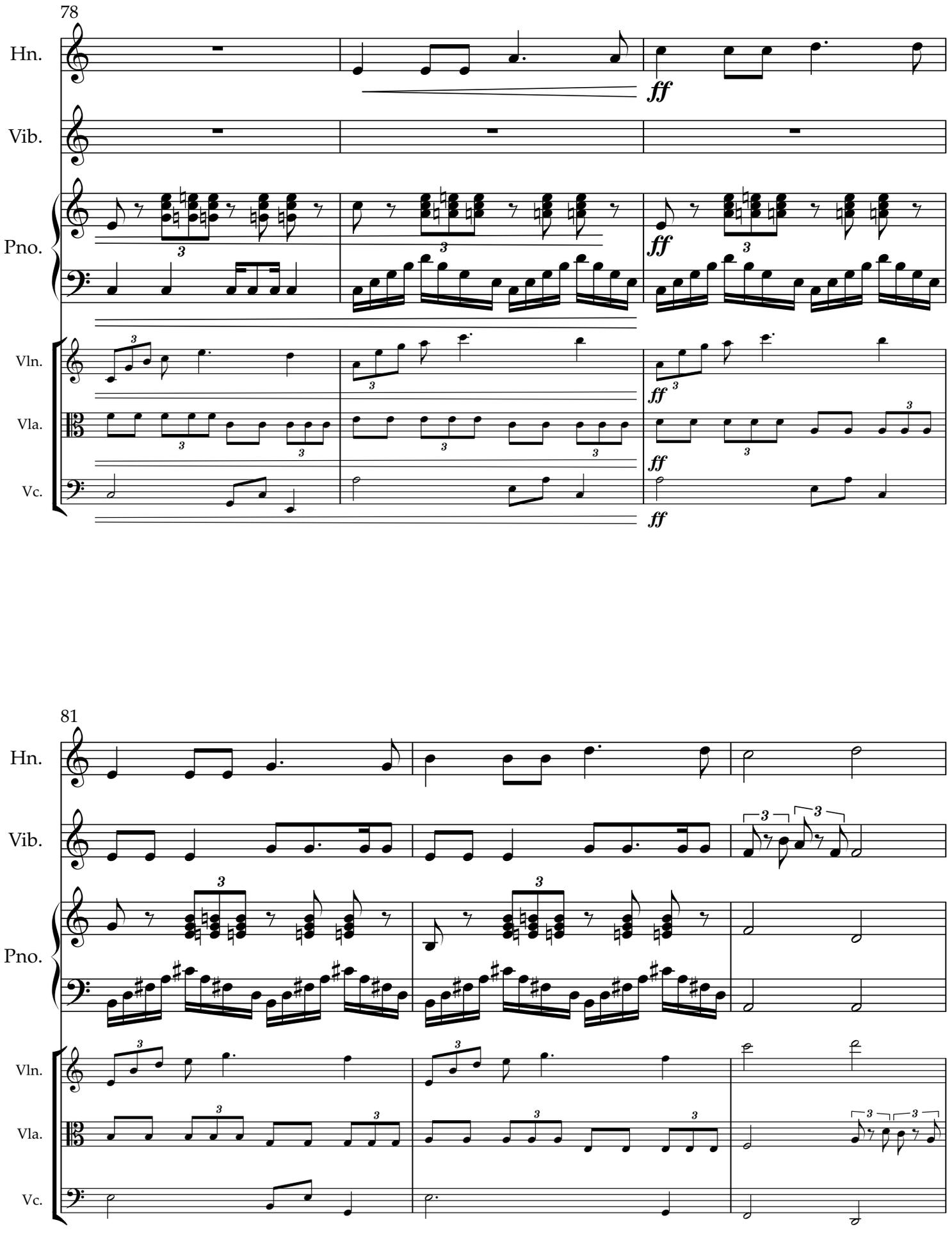

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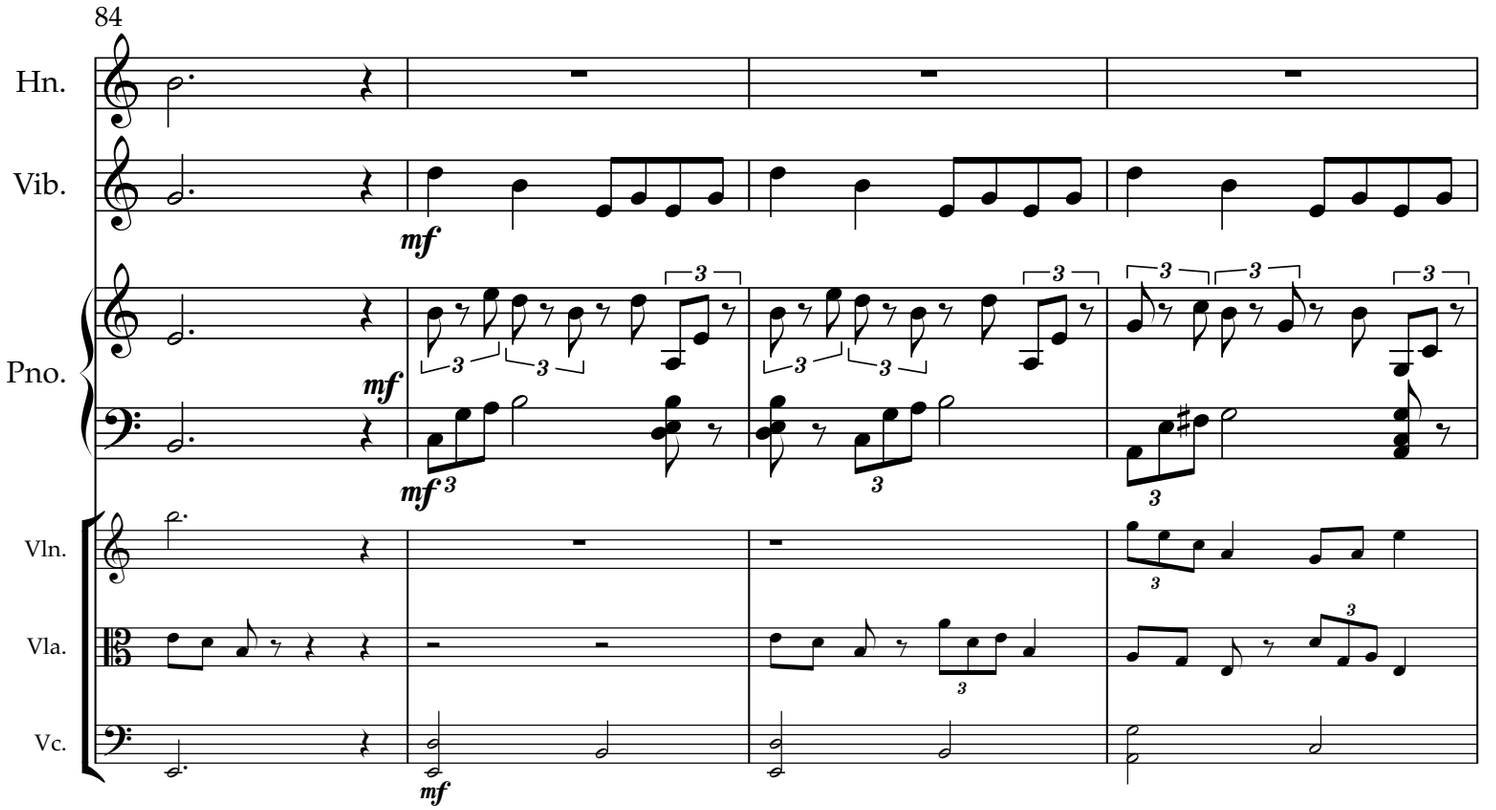

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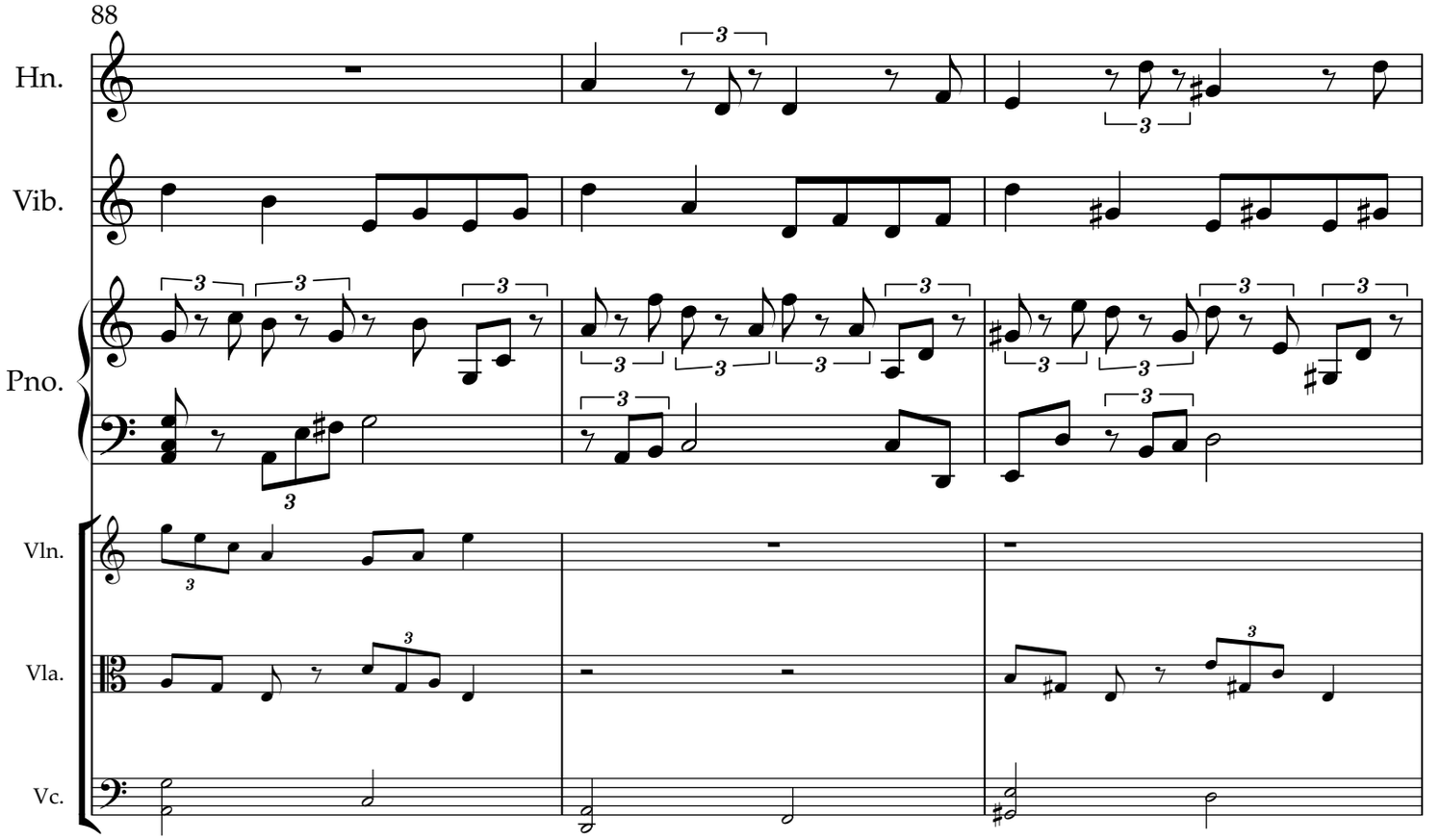

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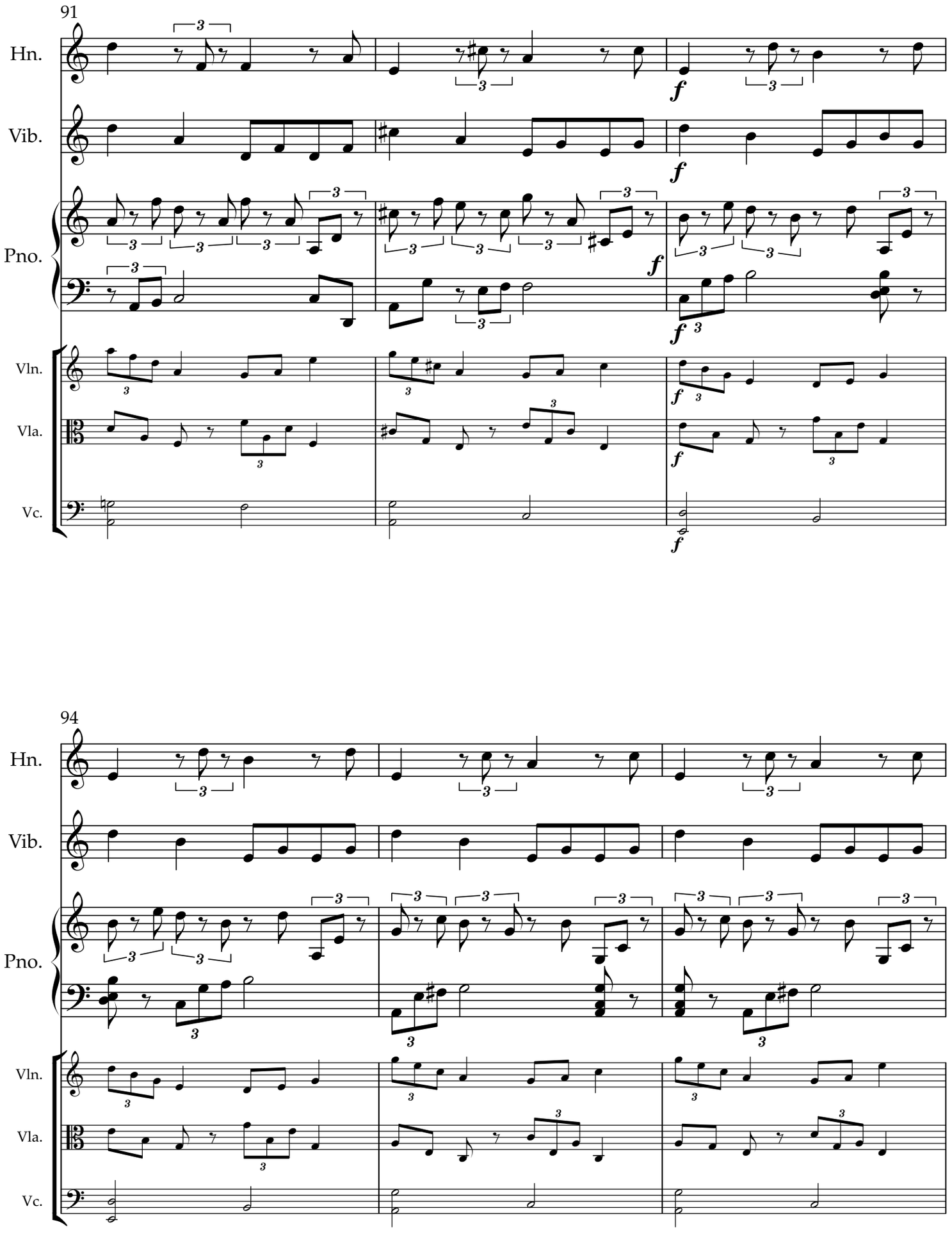

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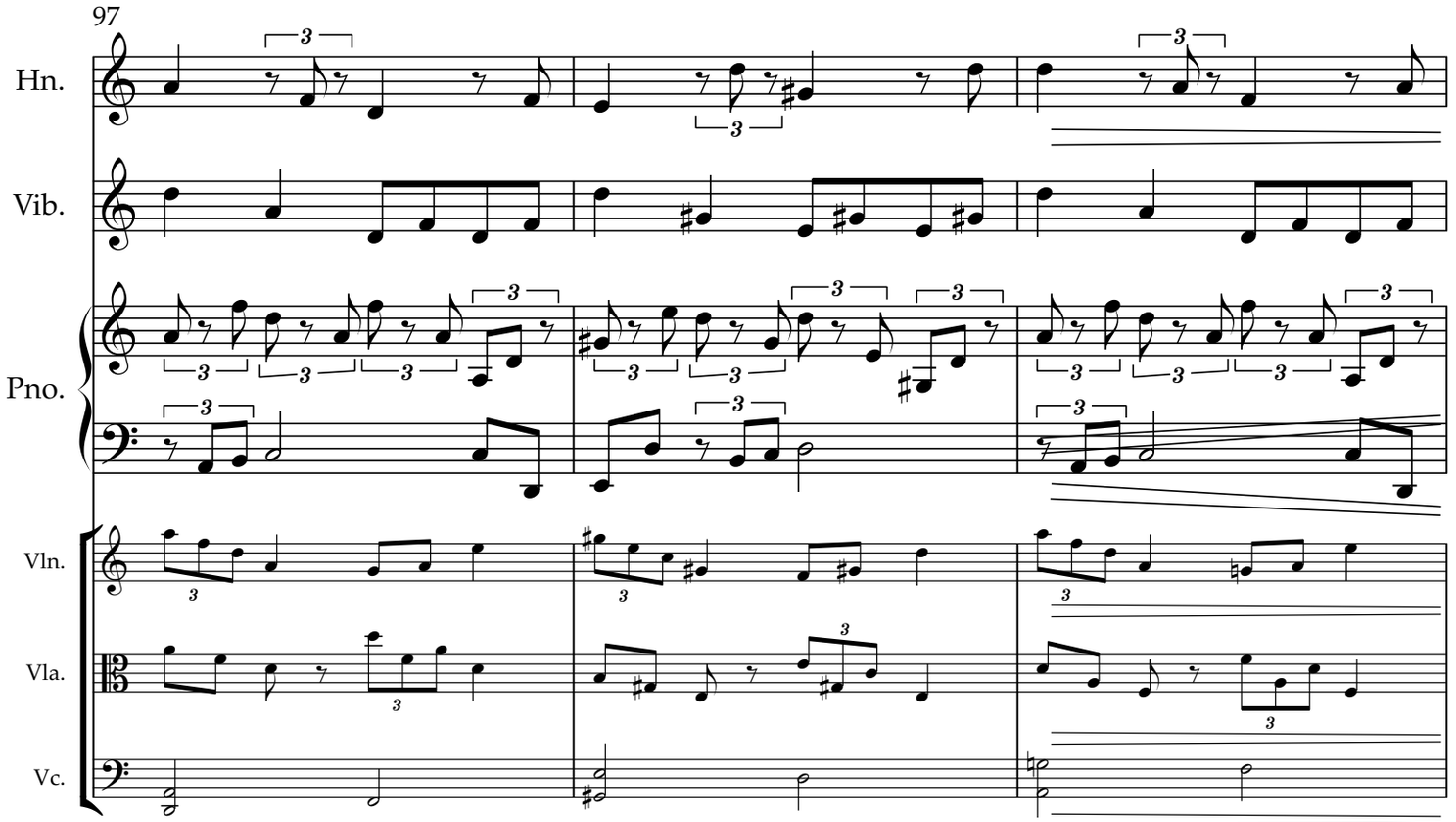

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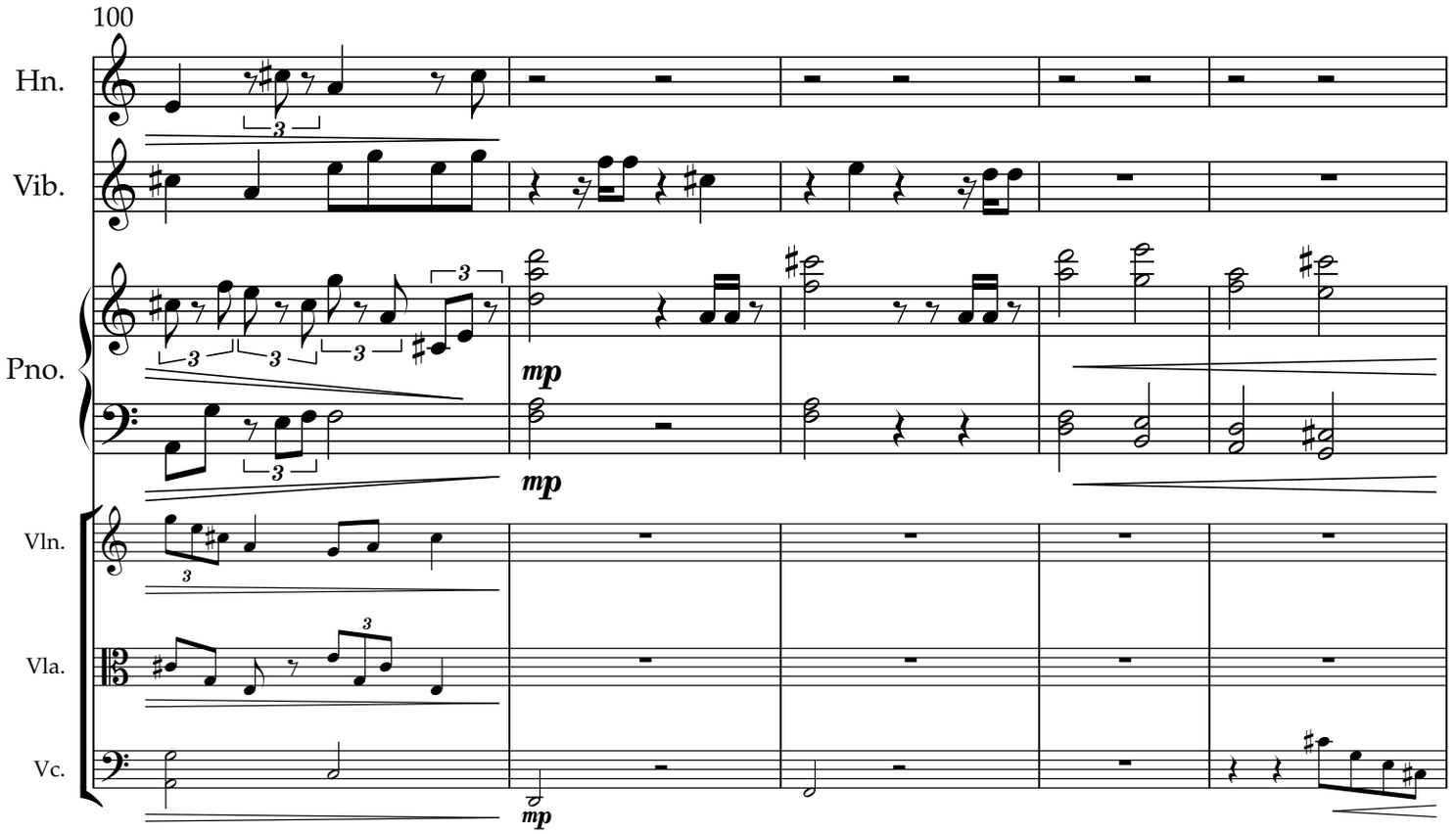

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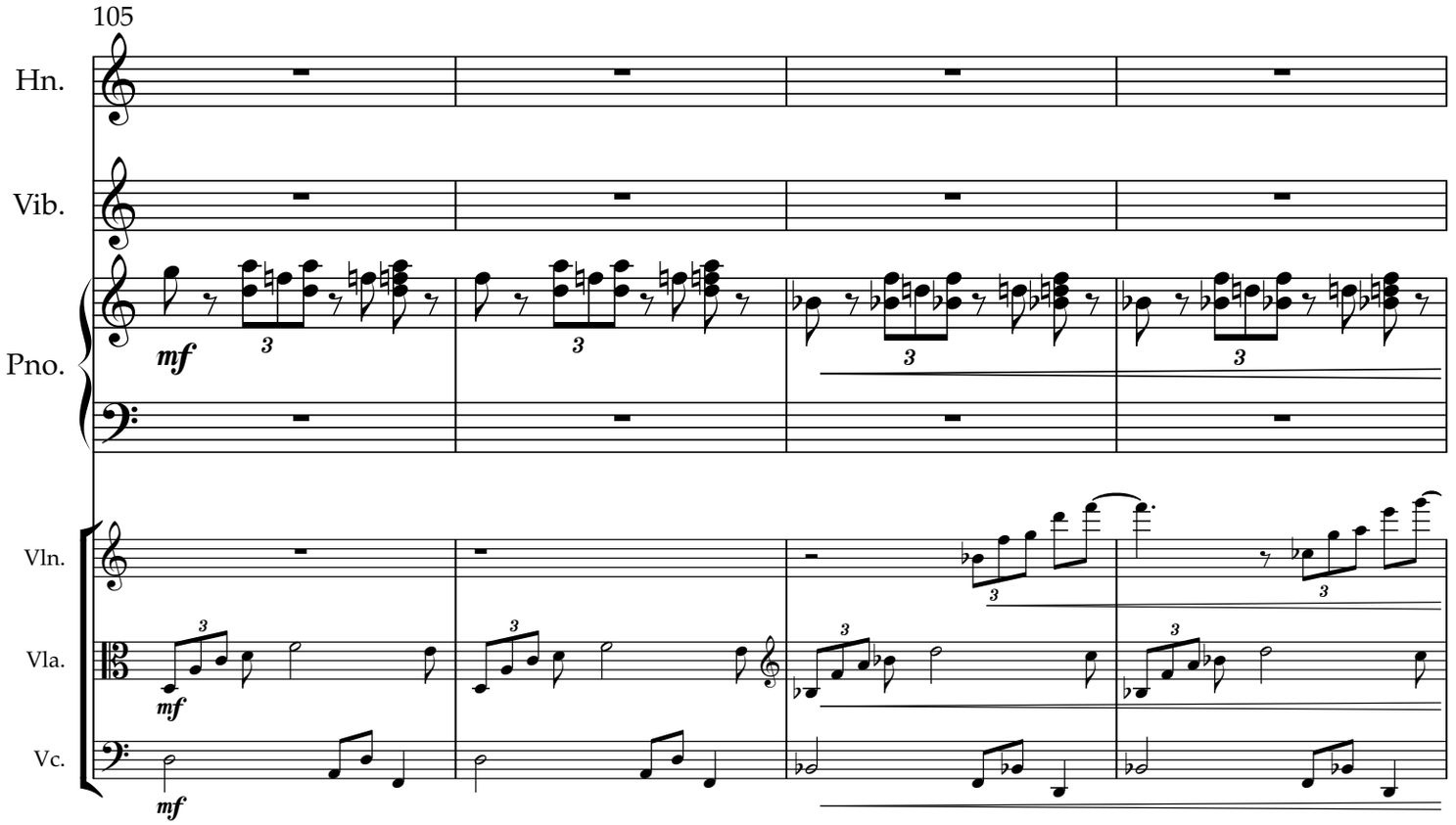

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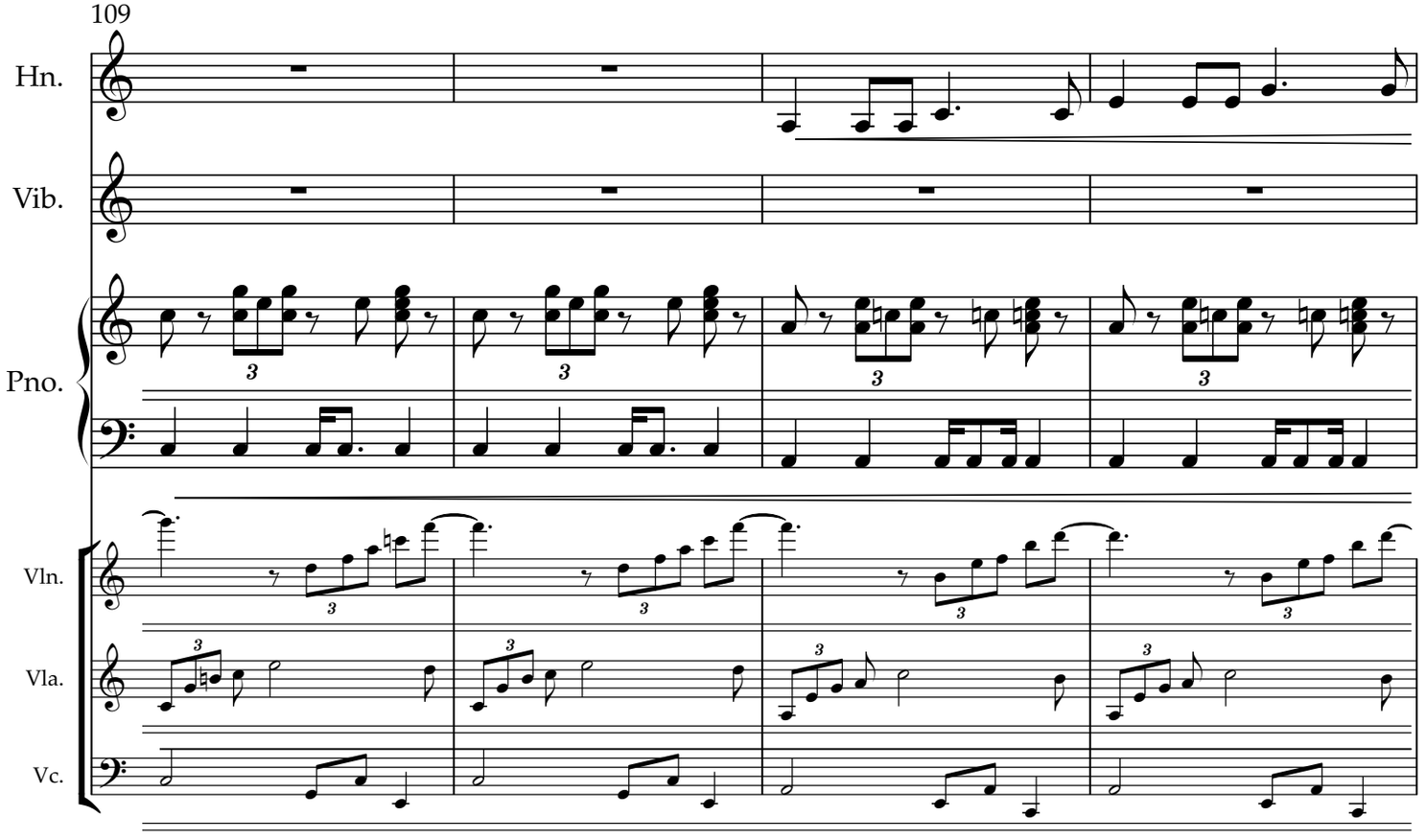

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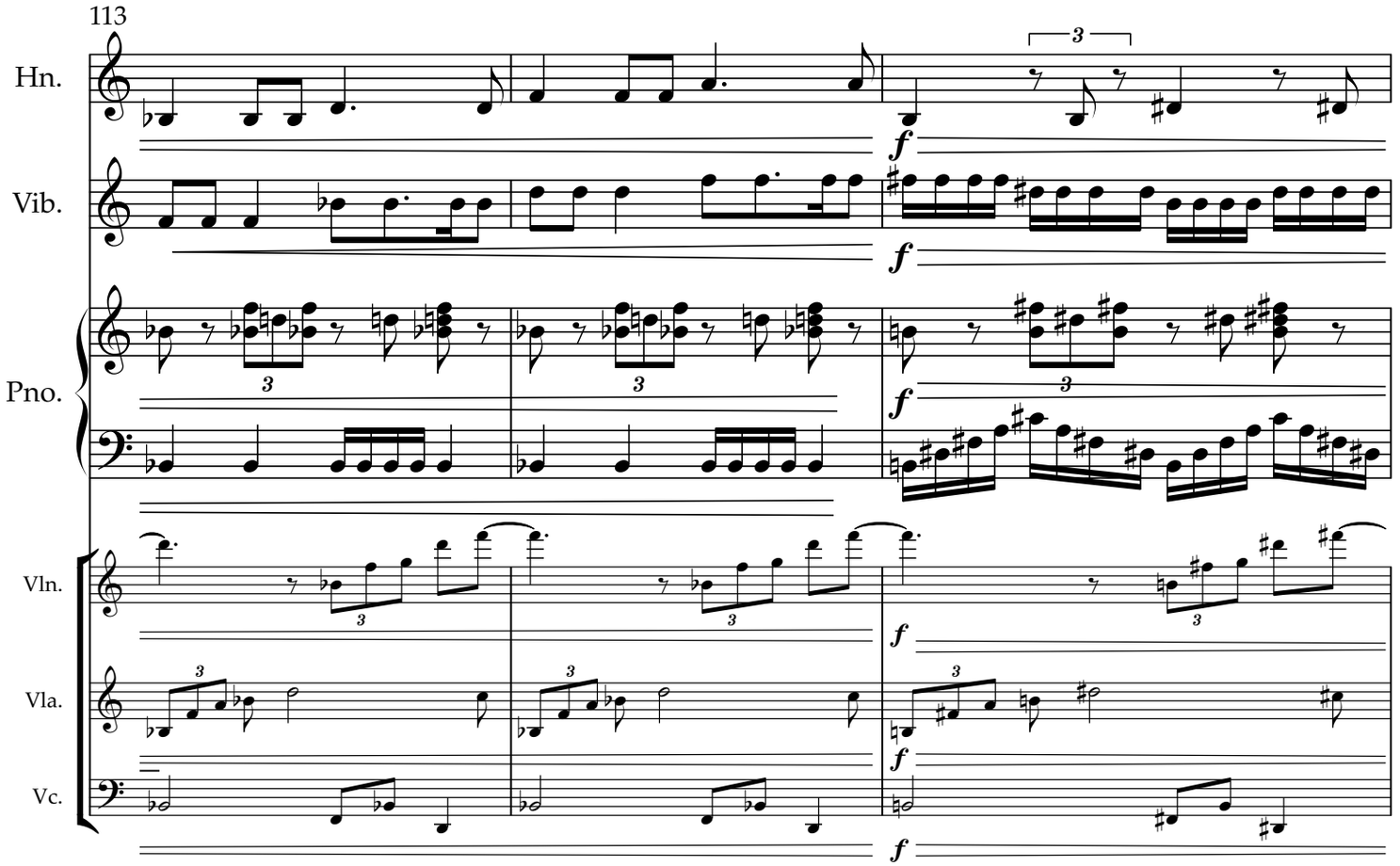

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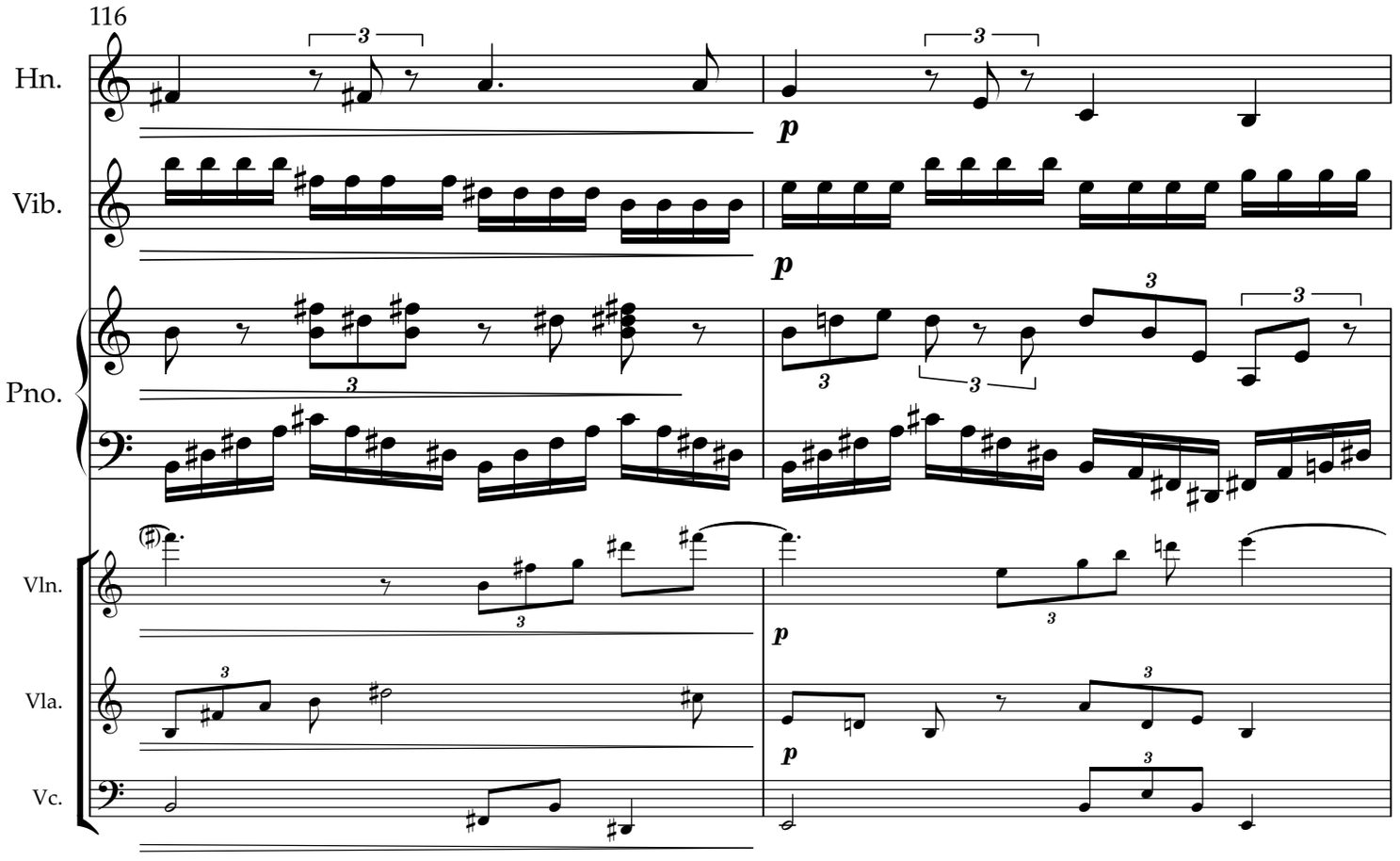

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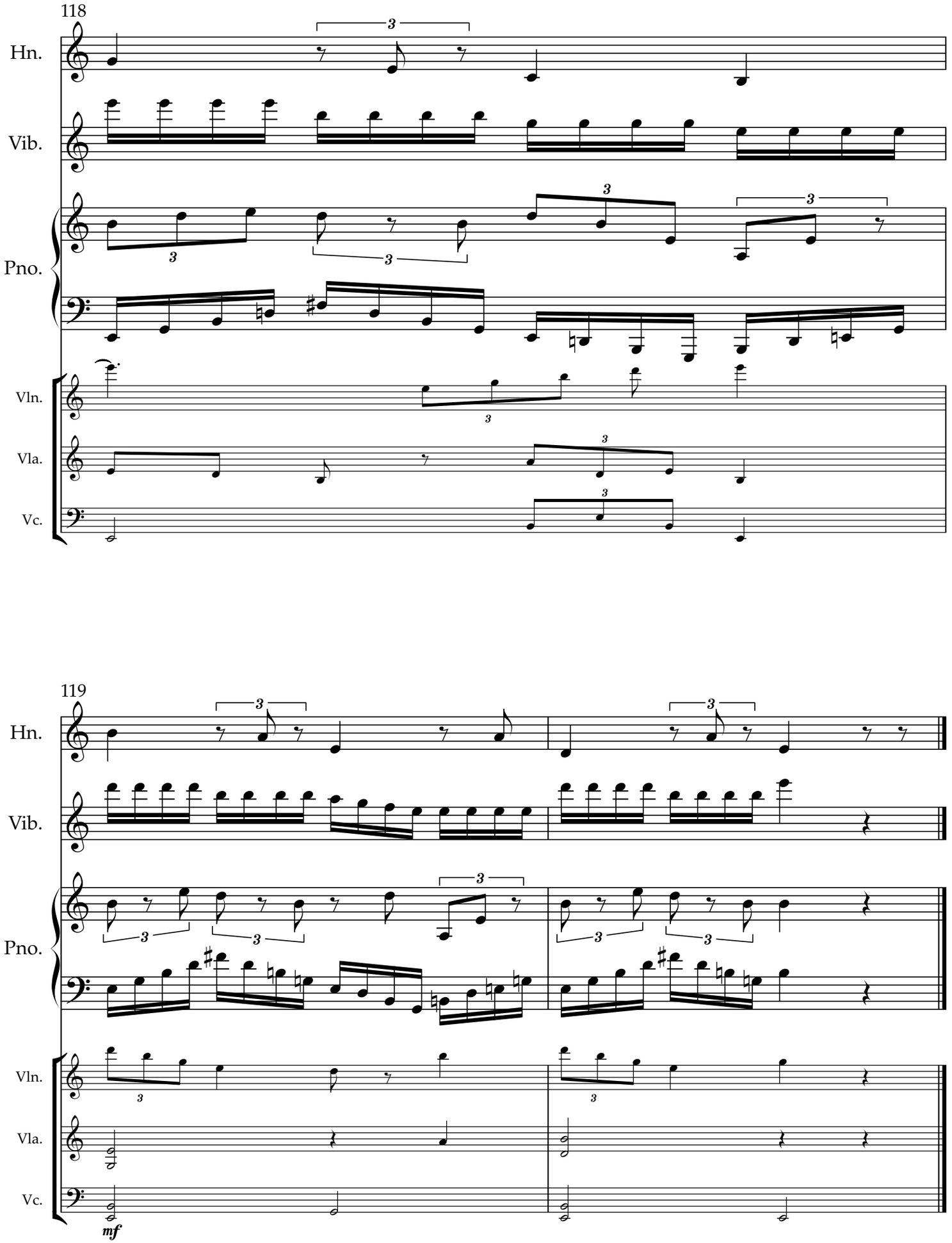

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